D2 – Admissibility (Revised Version 2.0)

Structural Criteria for Actions, Systems, and Self-Transformation in the Solution Space

1. Status and Function

D2 belongs to the normative layer of the set.

It formulates the conditions under which actions, systems, or structural changes in the solution space can be considered admissible.

It contains:

- no measurement methods (→ D3 / D3a),
- no operational implementation (→ D3a),
- no anthropological elaboration (→ D4 / D4a),
- no critical counter-examination (→ D6).

Its function is:

to define the minimal, non-compensable structural conditions

that must be fulfilled so that development in the solution space is not damaged.

This keeps D2 the normative layer of the set; measurement, approximation, and implementation are expressly subordinate.

2. Basic Form of Admissibility

Admissibility does not refer to:

- intentions,
- individual results,
- local performance,
- short-term effects.

Admissibility refers to:

the effect of an action, a system, or a structural change on the structure of possible future developmental paths.

Clarification

Local consistency, functional performance, or subjective plausibility are not sufficient indicators of structural admissibility.

This applies especially when they are based on distorted, incompletely visible, or strategically adapted relational patterns.

The difference between visible behavior and global structure is already marked in the set as a recurring problem.

2a. Extended Scope of Application

The admissibility conditions formulated in this document apply not only to:

- individual actions,
- institutional decisions,
- technical systems in the static sense.

They also apply to:

- processes of adaptation,
- processes of scaling,
- processes of self-transformation,
- processes of self-improvement,
- and recursive optimization loops.

Rationale
With the emergence of technically accelerated, globally networked, and recursively effective selection systems, the reach of decisions changes fundamentally.
Malbound, externalizing, or path-blind selection no longer acts only locally, but can covertly narrow or irreversibly close entire future paths.
It follows from this:
Not only the result of an optimization is normatively relevant.
The form of the optimization itself is also normatively relevant.

2b. Optimization under Admissibility Reservation

Not every form of optimization is admissible.
Optimization is admissible only when it itself remains within the non-compensable structural conditions.
Inadmissible in particular is any form of improvement or self-improvement in which:

- future developmental paths are structurally narrowed,
- irreversible bonds arise before sufficient proof was possible,
- or costs, risks, correction burdens, and control losses are outsourced to areas not carried along.

Clarification
The increase of individual target variables, performance metrics, or success indicators is not an independent admissibility criterion.
It can neither replace structural admissibility nor compensate for a violation of the admissibility conditions.
Therefore:
Not the maximization of local performance values,
but the preservation of the structural admissibility of the developmental trajectory
is normatively decisive.
This clarification is consistent with D3, which does not allow any dominant single metric, as well as with D6, which describes proxy breakage, alignment faking, and measurement displacement as systematic error forms.

2c. Complexity Formation under Admissibility Reservation

Not every form of complexity increase is admissible.
In particular, the following phenomena are also not independent admissibility criteria:

- resonance,
- self-organization,
- collective intelligence,
- technical performance increase,
- increased search-space opening,
- or strengthened coupling between systems.

They can be solution-space-promoting if they preserve path integrity, reversibility, and non-externalization. However, they can equally contribute to narrowing, pseudo-stabilization, over-coupling, or disempowerment.
Therefore:

Complexity formation is admissible only when the interdependencies it generates do not structurally close future developmental paths, do not create irreversible bonds without sufficient proof, and do not outsource costs, risks, or judgment burdens to areas not carried along.

3. Three Non-Compensable Questions

An action, a system, or a process of self-transformation is admissible only if all three questions can be answered positively.

Z1 – Path Integrity

Do future developmental paths remain structurally open?

Inadmissible is any action, any system, or any recursive improvement that:

- reduces the diversity of possible future developments,
- systematically excludes certain developments,
- or restricts the capacity for further differentiation.

Clarification

If

- covert decoupling,
- strategic pseudo-conformity,
- non-verifiable internal selection logics,
- or a silent closure of the search and decision space

are present, path integrity is not given.

This also applies when a system appears consistent, helpful, or rule-compliant under observation,

but its selection structure is only superficially bound to reality coupling.

Extension to self-improving systems

Path integrity is also violated when a system organizes its own development in such a way that later correction, dissent, or alternative paths are factually displaced.

Accelerated improvement is not a counter-argument when it is purchased at the price of structural closure.

Extension: Resonance and coupling path

Path integrity is also endangered when a system, through high coupling, apparent coherence, or strong collective synchronization, displaces alternative interpretations, dissent, or later reorientation.

A development remains path-integral only when the coupling it generates does not lead to a silent closure of the search, perception, or decision space.

Z2 – Irreversibility

Do irreversible effects arise that are no longer correctable?

Inadmissible is any action, any system, or any self-transformation that:

- creates non-recoverable states,
- acts without sufficient possibility for correction,
- or prevents future adaptation.

Clarification

Irreversibility can arise through:

- cumulative effects,

- structural path binding,
- creeping narrowing without explicit decision,
- premature scaling,
- or a stepwise replacement of real agency by functional dependency.

Even irreversibility that is not explicitly perceived is relevant.

Extension to self-improving systems

Self-improvement is inadmissible when it condenses in such a way that later revision is only formally possible but practically no longer realistically feasible.

Irreversibility does not begin only with open rupture,
but already where revision costs, dependencies, or connection losses become factually unbearable.

Z3 – Externalization

Are costs or risks outsourced?

Inadmissible is any action, any system, or any improvement that:

- spatially, temporally, or structurally shifts negative effects,
- relocates responsibility out of the system context,
- renders burdens invisible,
- or transfers the burden of examination, correction, and risk assumption to carriers who do not effectively co-decide on the change.

Clarification

Externalization can occur through:

- temporal delay,
- systemic displacement,
- structural intransparency,
- apparent relief with real dependency,
- or the relocation of epistemic work onto insufficiently informed human or institutional carriers.

Even indirect and difficult-to-recognize externalization is relevant.

Extension to self-improving systems

A system also externalizes when it purchases its own performance increase through forms of decoupling, silent judgment outsourcing, or later correction burden.

Local improvement with global or later deterioration remains inadmissible.

4. Non-Compensability

The three questions are not offsettable against each other.

A positive evaluation in one area cannot compensate for a negative evaluation in another.

In particular:

- high performance does not compensate for path narrowing,
- great utility does not compensate for irreversibility,
- and recognizable efficiency does not compensate for externalization.

The same applies to processes of recursive improvement:
an accelerated gain in knowledge or performance cannot legitimize the violation of a non-compensable structural condition.

5. Uncertainty and Hold

If one of the three questions cannot be answered sufficiently,
no positive admissibility decision is possible.
In this case the following applies:
Hold.
Meaning of Hold
Hold means:

- no irreversible decision,
- no further path narrowing,
- no externalization,
- continuation of examination under improved conditions.

Extension
Hold does not mean standstill as an end in itself.
Hold means:

- limitation of the intervention,
- renunciation of premature upscaling,
- expansion of the examination basis,
- and continuation of clarification in a form that preserves revisability.

This keeps Hold the normative expression of what is later operationalized in D3 and D3a as limited proof, multi-instance approximation, and reversible learning loops.
6. Relation to Measurement and Implementation
D2 makes no statements about
how the three questions are to be concretely measured or verified.
This task lies with:

- D3 (Approximation and Measurement Logic),
- D3a (Operational Implementation).

D2 does not define the metrics.
D2 defines the boundary within which metrics may legitimately be used at all.
Precisely for this reason, no single success variable may take the place of the three structural questions.
7. Relation to the Interface
D2 presupposes that:

- perception,
- judgment,
- dissent,
- and decision

remain preserved in the interface.
These conditions are treated in D4 and D4a.
Clarification
The admissibility question must not be silently delegated to systems
whose own selection logic is itself the subject of examination.
Especially in contexts of growing AI use, the preservation of real human connection, judgment, and decision agency remains a condition of admissibility,
even if its concrete elaboration does not occur in D2 but in D4/D4a.

8. Relation to Critique

D2 presupposes that:

- maldevelopments can be recognized,
- protective mechanisms remain verifiable,
- and systematic risks remain visible.

These conditions are treated in D6.

Clarification

Precisely because systems can appear locally consistent and yet remain structurally problematic, admissibility must always stand under the reservation of possible counter-examination.

A framework that does not carry its own critique with it cannot stably maintain its admissibility claims.

9. Closing Principle

Admissibility is not a state.

It is a structural condition under open future relations.

An action, a system, or a process of self-transformation is admissible only
when the structure of possible future development is not damaged.

In technically accelerated, recursively effective systems this condition sharpens:

Not only the current action,
but also the form of its own improvement
must remain bound to path integrity, revisability, and non-externalization.